Yemen Conflict and Global Trade

GS II

- Yemen lies beside the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, a narrow passage connecting the Red Sea with important international shipping routes. Fighting near this **maritime chokepoint** can endanger commercial vessels and disrupt the movement of goods between regions.

- The conflict becomes more dangerous because the Houthis receive Iranian support while the internationally recognised Yemeni government receives Saudi backing. This **external involvement** connects Yemen's internal struggle with wider regional rivalries and security concerns.

- Attacks on ships and energy infrastructure can force vessels to avoid dangerous waters, increasing **transportation costs** and delaying supplies. Disruptions become especially serious when other important routes, including the Strait of Hormuz, face restrictions.

- Military operations alone have struggled to end the fighting because the opposing groups retain political and military interests. A lasting settlement requires negotiations within Yemen alongside efforts to reduce **regional tensions** and protect maritime security.

Yemen's conflict demonstrates how internal instability, regional rivalries and vulnerable shipping routes can combine to threaten international commerce, making political settlement essential for lasting security.